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ENGLISH LANGUAGE STANDARD TWO

Midterm exam - March · Reading Skills 2026
Answer Key and Worked Solutions

Subject	English Language
Code	Not printed in source
Level	Standard Two
Year	2026
Exam Board / Issuer	MESP Tanzania
Exam	Midterm exam - March · Reading Skills
Type	Answer key and worked solutions
Questions	50 individually answered tasks/parts (oral items included)

Try each question before checking the solution. Follow the steps, compare your working, and practise the parts you find difficult.

Source paper: English-S2-2026-MESP-Tanzania-March-Midterm-exam.pdf

Notes about the source paper

Items with missing information or printing errors are explained in their solutions. A model response is an example, rather than a prescribed official answer.

Vocabulary and grammar

1. Which word begins with the same sound as ball? (A boy, B cat, C dog)

Step 1: Ball and boy begin with /b/.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: A. Boy.

2. A cow gives us ___. (A milk, B water, C grass)

Step 1: Cows produce milk.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: A. Milk.

3. Choose the plural of book. (A bookes, B books, C book)

Step 1: Add s to the regular noun book.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: B. Books.

4. Choose the opposite of big. (A short, B small, C long)

Step 1: Small contrasts with big in size.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: B. Small.

5. Arrange Playing, are, children, the into a sentence.

Step 1: Put the subject first, then the plural auxiliary are and the -ing action.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: The children are playing.

6. Choose the past tense of jump. (A jumps, B jumping, C jumped)

Step 1: Add ed to make the regular past tense.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: C. Jumped.

7. The boy is eating a mango. What is he eating? (A banana, B mango, C orange)

Step 1: The sentence directly names the food.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: B. Mango.

8. Which word rhymes with cat? (A pen, B hat, C dog)

Step 1: Cat and hat share the ending sound /æt/.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: B. Hat.

9. She ___ to school every day. (A go, B goes, C going)

Step 1: She is singular; the habitual present verb takes es.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: B. Goes.

10. There are ___ days in a week. (A four, B seven, C eight)

Step 1: Monday to Sunday gives seven days.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: B. Seven.

11. I ___ many animals. (know, no)

Step 1: Know means be familiar with; no is a negative response.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Know.

12. That stone is ___. (herd, hard)

Step 1: Hard describes the stone's firmness.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Hard.

13. Mr. Mollel keeps a big ___ of cattle. (hard, herd)

Step 1: Herd is a group of cattle.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Herd.

14. We carry things in a ___. (curt, cart)

Step 1: A cart is a vehicle for carrying goods.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Cart.

15. We use a pencil to ___. (right, write)

Step 1: Write is the action of forming words.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Write.

16. My uncle John keeps many ___. (pigs, bigs)

Step 1: Pigs are animals; bigs is not the required noun.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Pigs.

17. Our mother cooks food in a _____. (boat, pot)

Step 1: A pot is a cooking container.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Pot.

18. Where is the other ____? I saw it eating grass. (got, goat)

Step 1: A goat is an animal that eats grass.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Goat.

19. Did you ____ the cock crowing? (hear, here)

Step 1: Hear is the verb for perceiving sound.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Hear.

20. My father likes to wear a _____. (hat, hut)

Step 1: A hat is worn on the head; a hut is a building.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Hat.

Section Summary: Use sentence meaning, subject agreement and time clues to choose the word or verb form. Apply the specific rule explained for each task and note ambiguous choices.

Picture vocabulary

21. Name picture 21. The source illustration shows a sitting domestic canine with a pointed muzzle and tail.

Step 1: Identify the visible object or animal and spell its name dog.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Dog.

22. Name picture 22. The source illustration shows furniture with pillows, a mattress and blanket.

Step 1: Identify the visible object or animal and spell its name bed.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Bed.

23. Name picture 23. The source illustration shows an open cardboard container with four folded flaps.

Step 1: Identify the visible object or animal and spell its name box.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Box.

24. Name picture 24. The source illustration shows a blue enclosed road vehicle with several windows.

Step 1: Identify the visible object or animal and spell its name van.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Van.

25. Name picture 25. The source illustration shows a small hand-held cylindrical electric light.

Step 1: Identify the visible object or animal and spell its name torch/flashlight.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Torch/flashlight.

26. Name picture 26. The source illustration shows a long-handled digging tool with a flat square blade.

Step 1: Identify the visible object or animal and spell its name spade.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Spade.

27. Name picture 27. The source illustration shows a wild canine with thick fur, a pointed muzzle and upright ears.

Step 1: Identify the visible object or animal and spell its name wolf.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Wolf.

28. Name picture 28. The source illustration shows a group of leafy and other edible garden plants.

Step 1: Identify the visible object or animal and spell its name vegetables.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Vegetables.

29. Name picture 29. The source illustration shows a long limbless reptile.

Step 1: Identify the visible object or animal and spell its name snake.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Snake.

30. Name picture 30. The source illustration shows a utensil with a handle and shallow oval bowl.

Step 1: Identify the visible object or animal and spell its name spoon.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Spoon.

Section Summary: Observe the pictured object or action. Name its identifying features and use correct spelling; action sentences use is or are with an ing verb.

Removing initial sounds

31. Delete the first sound from clock and write the new word.

Step 1: Remove the initial /k/ sound, leaving lock.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: lock.

32. Delete the first sound from fear and write the new word.

Step 1: Remove /f/, leaving ear.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: ear.

33. Delete the first sound from Fight and write the new word.

Step 1: Removing /f/ leaves /ait/, written ight; the printed task cannot produce a normal word.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: ight (not a normal standalone word).

34. Delete the first sound from Box and write the new word.

Step 1: Remove /b/, leaving ox.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: ox.

35. Delete the first sound from Strain and write the new word.

Step 1: Remove the first /s/ sound, leaving train.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: train.

36. Delete the first sound from Box and write the new word.

Step 1: Remove /b/, leaving ox.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: ox.

37. Delete the first sound from Bread and write the new word.

Step 1: Remove the initial /b/ sound; the remaining /red/ is the past pronunciation of read.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: read (pronounced red).

38. Delete the first sound from Glove and write the new word.

Step 1: Remove /g/, leaving love.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: love.

39. Delete the first sound from Stone and write the new word.

Step 1: Remove /s/, leaving tone.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: tone.

40. Delete the first sound from Scare and write the new word.

Step 1: Remove /s/, leaving care.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: care.

Section Summary: Distinguish speech sounds from written letters. Blend consonants, recognise digraphs and compare pronunciations when identifying rhymes or homophones.

Comprehension

41. How old is Musa?

Step 1: The second sentence states his age.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Seven years old.

42. What did Musa's mother do on the morning of 13 January?

Step 1: These actions appear together at the start of the birthday account.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: She woke him up, hugged him and wished him a happy birthday.

43. What present did Musa receive from his mother?

Step 1: The passage directly names her gift.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: A nice shirt.

44. What present did Musa receive from his father?

Step 1: The passage directly names his gift.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: A new pair of shoes.

45. What did Musa and his friends do?

Step 1: The narrator describes these activities after the meal.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: They sang and danced cheerfully.

46. What is the name of the person who wrote this story?

Step 1: The first-person account starts 'My name is Musa', which identifies its narrator, not necessarily the writer.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Musa is the narrator; the actual author is not named.

47. When was Musa's birthday?

Step 1: The opening says his birthday was on 13 January.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: 13 January.

48. The birthday was enjoyable and ____.

Step 1: This adjective completes the printed description.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Memorable.

49. How did Musa feel after being given presents?

Step 1: The final sentence says he was very happy.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Very happy.

50. When the neighbours came, they ate delicious food and drank ____.

Step 1: The passage names fresh fruit juice as their drink.

Step 2: Use this rule or evidence to write the answer below.

Final Answer: Fresh fruit juice.

Section Summary: Find evidence in the passage or poem before answering. Distinguish explicit statements, reasonable inferences and model interpretations.

Source Checks

MESP TZ Standard Two Midterm Examinations March 2026